

THE ESTATE

PROPERTY GUIDE

HARRODS

NIGERIA'S PLAYGROUND

KENSINGTON

ST EDWARDS LATEST EDITION

CAPE VERDE

THE MIAMI OF AFRICA

SECRET OF INVESTING IN AFRICA

INVEST FROM WITHIN

REDEFINING AFRICAN LUXURY

API CEO JOSEPH FARODOYE

PROPERTY • PEOPLE • CULTURE • TRAVEL

estatepropertyguide.com

V
ONE
£3.99
\$5.99

KENSINGTON HIGH STREET LONDON



Proud to be a member of the
Berkeley Group of companies



FIND YOURSELF IN THE CLOUDS

*Sales & Marketing Suite open daily
10am to 6pm (Thursdays until 8pm).*

Show apartments now launched Enquire
now at +44 (0)20 3813 9255

www.375kensingtonhighstreet.co.uk

Images are indicative only. Prices correct at time of print.

Completely Kensington. Completely you.

Live in the height of luxury at 375 Kensington High Street, with elegant and contemporary interiors, bespoke leisure facilities including vitality pool, spa, sauna, state-of-the-art gymnasium, private cinema, Harrods concierge service and breathtaking views from one of London's most sought after new addresses.

1, 2 and 3 bedrooms apartments and penthouses
from £1,240,000.

Selected apartments available for immediate occupation.

St Edward
Designed for life



AFRICA REDISCOVERED...

www.africapropertyinvest.com

API
AFRICA PROPERTY INVEST

REDEFINING AFRICAN LUXURY A MESSAGE FROM THE FOUNDER

ENJOYING YOUR LIFE WITHOUT LIMITATION



On my quest to explore the luxury African experience through Nigerian eyes, I encountered many richly diverse realities. From playing Polo, on horseback in the tranquil landscapes of Kaduna Nigeria, to wild game hunting in the sun scorched plains of the Serengeti, Tanzania. Or partying in the moonlight till the early hours, on the golden sandy beaches of Durban, South Africa. Perhaps, a spot of wind Kite Surfing on the shores of Sal, Cape Verde, or even Yacht Sailing across the turquoise waters of Mauritius, before flying by private jet to enjoy shopping on the plush streets of Monaco.

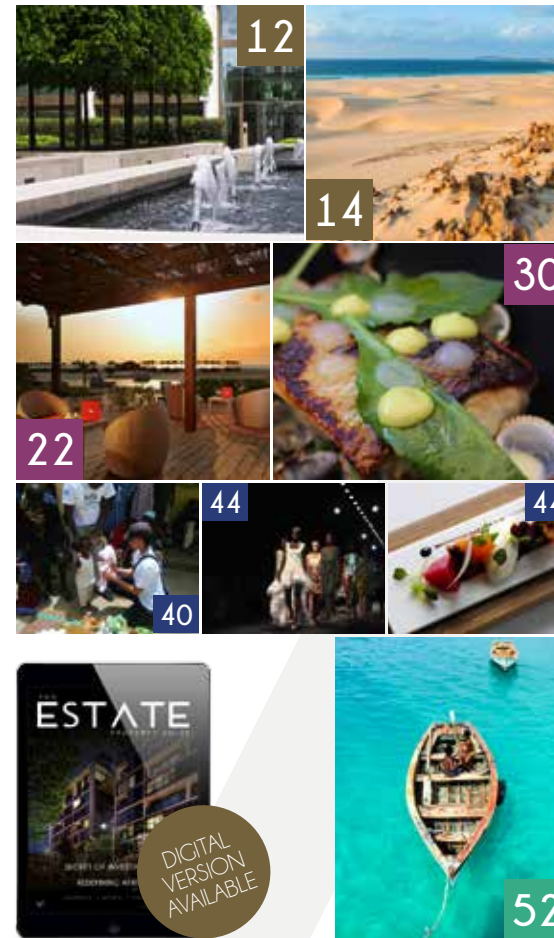
I quickly realised that the African experience has no international barriers or boundaries, the experience takes you all over the world, rubbing minds with people from different cultures, sharing in amazing cuisine prepared by the finest chefs, enjoying architecture from different civilisations, whilst indulging in a world without limitations. As Africa is the birth place of civilisation, and home to more than 1.4 billion people, it is fitting for the African experience to be as diverse as its people in a global village that has now begun to acknowledge and encourage the beauty of African culture.

WELCOME TO THE ESTATE PROPERTY GUIDE

with respect
Joseph Farodoye

CONTENT

VOLUME ONE



THE COLLECTIVE

Joseph Farodoye
Founder

Uyai Akpan
Head Of Operations

Kemi Sulu
Head Of Finance

Mehetabel Merid
Head Of Distribution

Dean Christmas
Senior Designer

Zaccarie Farodoye
Assistant Researcher

Anthonia Agbelusi
International Liaison (Puerto Bonus)

Paola Audrey Ndengue
International Liaison (Paris)

Contributors:
Dr Frederick B Oduola
Mary T Salami

Eyrcia Freemantle
John Chuka Mbanefo
Denice Refael
Paola Audrey Ndengue
Amanda Meshida-Banjo
Jeff Barnes

Interviews:
Princess Modupe Ozolua
Rob Jarrett

Publisher:
Africa Property Invest (API)

Printing & Finishing:
Pureprint Group

Image Credit:
J&E Media
Josh Meilach

Welcome to the Estate Property Guide,
the authority on property, lifestyle and
all things luxury across Africa

#redefiningafricanluxury

PROPERTY

property@estatepropertyguide.co.uk

PG12-13 Kensington St Edwards Latest Edition

PG14-15 Cape Verde: the Miami of Africa

PEOPLE

people@estatepropertyguide.co.uk

Up Close and Personal with
PG22-25 Rob Jarrett Ceo of the Resort Group

PG30-32 Changing Face of Beauty

PG34-36 Banking in Nigeria

CULTURE

culture@estatepropertyguide.co.uk

PG37-39 Africa - Investing from within

PG40-43 Charity Begins at Home
with Princess Modupe Ozolua

PG44-46 What Is The Point in
Africa Fashion Weeks

TRAVEL

travel@estatepropertyguide.co.uk

PG50-51 A Picture of Health

PG52-55 Tourism Potential in Nigeria

PG57 Our Children are awash
in a sea of data

If you would like to subscribe to receive your
quarterly edition of the Estate Property Guide
then please email
subscription@estatepropertyguide.co.uk

PERSON OF THE MOMENT

DAME JULIE COKER

It gives The Estate Property Guide great pleasure to dedicate this special tribute to Dame Julie Coker a committed journalist, television broadcaster, and an icon within the Nigerian community.

As one of the first female television broadcasters in Africa, Dame Julie Coker helped to inspire a generation, nurturing countless media professionals and mentoring so many prominent figures within Nigerian society.

A former Miss Nigeria and Miss West Africa beauty queen, Dame Julie Coker's grace and finesse helped to establish NTA (Nigerian Television Authority) as one of the forerunners of news on the African continent.

A friend to numerous Hollywood stars including Harry Belafonte and Sidney Poitier to name a few, Dame Julie Coker truly helped to influence the way Nigerian women were perceived in the media and around the world. As a dedicated professional with a career spanning more than 50 years as a broadcaster, we see it fitting that we share her story to a new budding generation in the hope that it will continue to inspire and illustrate to all that with self-belief and determination you too can achieve iconic status.

As an award winning innovator, the Estate Property Guide would like to thank you for your dedication, and the shining example of excellence you have demonstrated throughout your career.

Dame Julie Coker the Estate Property Guide salutes you and welcomes you as a senior member of the Advisory board.



AFRICA...AT YOUR FINGER TIPS

DISREGARD YOUR ISSUES, PUT TO REST YOUR TROUBLES, ALLOW US TO TAKE CARE OF THE DETAILS SO THAT YOU CAN CONCENTRATE ON THE FINER THINGS IN LIFE. OUR DISCREET SERVICE CONNECTS YOU WHERE YOU WANT TO BE...WHEN YOU WANT TO BE THERE.

ESTATE

PLATINUM CONCEIRGE

ESTATEPROPERTYGUIDE.COM

REST IN PEACE
PRINCE ROGERS NELSON



SUNRISE
JUNE 7, 1958

SUNSET
APRIL 21, 2016

THE
ESTATE
PROPERTY GUIDE

PROPERTY

375 KENSINGTON HIGH STREET

Located at one of London's most fashionable addresses, St Edward's prestigious development, 375 Kensington High Street offers the height of luxury living in a sought-after neighbourhood.



Replacing a series of unsightly office and retail buildings, the development has been thoughtfully designed to emulate a 'garden in the city', creating a peaceful oasis in the heart of Kensington. In keeping with the traditional surrounds of Kensington and Chelsea's traditional garden squares, courtyards and greenery, 375 Kensington High Street provides residents with a central landscaped courtyard and water feature, offering a sense of space, light and calm in the middle of a bustling city.

Paul Vallone, Executive Chairman of St Edward, said: "375 Kensington High Street really stands out from other homes in the Capital. Its dedicated 24 hour Harrods concierge, spa and leisure facilities, cinema, swimming pool and massage treatment rooms combined with finely crafted interiors and community feel offer a quality of life unique in the Royal borough.

375 Kensington High Street is a key part of the wider Warwick Road masterplan, transforming this corner of the High Street into a thriving new community on the doorstep of some of the world's best universities and leading independent schools, including Imperial College London and Westminster School.

The development is ideally located for international travel and is served by both superb rail and air connections. Nearby High Street Kensington underground station is only three stops from Knightsbridge and five stops from Bond Street. In addition, there are convenient transport links to Heathrow, Gatwick, City Airport and St Pancras International station which provides Eurostar services to mainland Europe.



The eagerly anticipated development by the leading London developer has been uniquely designed to complement its regal surroundings which include Kensington Palace, the Royal Albert Hall and the Victoria and Albert Museum. The area is renowned for its royal parks and Michelin star restaurants, while famous former residents including Sir Andrew Lloyd Webber and Beatrix Potter have helped Kensington earn its reputation for culture and art.

When complete, 375 Kensington High Street will comprise of more than 500 homes including apartments and penthouses, and will transform this corner of the Capital into a flourishing new community.

Benson House, which boasts breath taking views over west London is the latest phase at 375 Kensington High Street and offers a magnificent collection of one, two and three bedroom apartments, duplexes and penthouses.

Selected Apartments are available for immediate occupation at 375 Kensington High Street.
Prices start from £1,240,000

St Edward Homes, established in March 2008, delivers major residential and mixed-use development schemes across London and the South East, focusing initially on three developments which will create a total of 2,500 new homes. Berkeley Homes and Prudential are equal shareholders in St Edward Homes Limited. The value of joint venture started at approximately £48 million, combining the initial investment by the two companies together with the land value of the three sites.

Cape Verde

THE MIAMI OF AFRICA

New development on Cape Verde's Boa Vista points to a fascinating investment opportunity from The Resort Group

THE
RESORT
GROUP
PLC

The Resort Group is guaranteeing an off-plan incentive of 7% per annum return during the hotel's construction phase...

'Sal has grown up, and our successful investment model is set to be replicated in Boa Vista. Like Sal, the island will become a property investment hotspot and the reasons for this are simple. Its stunning beaches, year-round sunshine and increasing number of direct flights from across the UK and Europe will entice people looking for an alternative holiday destination.'

835 Properties

White Sands Hotel & Spa will consist of 835 villas and hotel suites. Facilities include a choice of four themed restaurants and two large buffet style restaurants, a range of bars including a relaxing lobby bar, lively sports bar, late bar and nightclub, plus a champagne bar, and a selection of shops offering a variety of gifts, souvenirs and holiday essentials. In addition, guests will have access to six swimming pools, a YHI Spa and gym. For families, there will also be a kids' club, playground and baby pools.



White Sands Hotel & Spa CGI



Santa Monica Beach

Artist Impression of Main Entrance to hotel



White Sands

The five-star White Sands Hotel & Spa complex is the first of The Resort Group's six major developments on Boa Vista Island - all of which will be built on Santa Monica Beach - and forms part of the Cape Verde government's ambition for major tourist development. As well as approving plans for new hotels and resorts, the government is invested in enhancing the Island's infrastructure such as new roads, improved power supplies and desalination plants.

Ahead of the White Sands Hotel & Spa groundbreaking ceremony on Boa Vista, Rob Jarrett, CEO of The Resort Group, said: 'The tourism success of Cape Verde has largely been driven by the increasing number of visitors to the neighbouring Island of Sal, which is where our first three resort developments are located. Since opening, MELIÁ Tornega Beach Resort and MELIÁ Dunas Beach Resort & Spa have attracted over a million tourists, and Liana Beach Hotel, which is scheduled to open in 2016, will drive tourist volume even further.'

As long as people travel abroad, overseas property investors can enjoy strong rental yields over a long-term. This is especially true when the property is located in countries where there is guaranteed great weather, political stability, consistent growth in land values and a sustained level of government investment. When the property is managed by a good lettings or travel agency, the picture for investors becomes even brighter.

It's little wonder then that the Cape Verde Islands are causing such a stir among holidaymakers. The archipelago, situated some 500km off the west coast of Africa, boasts stunning scenery and year-round sunshine. There is such a variety of things to see and do that everyone, whether the romantic or adventurous type, can be forgiven for falling head over heels in love with these tropical and idyllic islands.

At the same time, property investors looking for a new buy-to-let opportunity on Cape Verde might be well served to consider purchasing a property at the new hotel complex currently under construction in Boa Vista - White Sands Hotel & Spa.

The New Place to Know



Boa Vista Shipwreck

The easternmost island of Cape Verde is the future home of The Resort Group's White Sands Hotel & Spa - stunning, untouched and with the lowest population in Cape Verde. It translates from Portuguese as 'beautiful view' and the island doesn't disappoint with pure white beaches, sand dune landscapes and breath-taking horizons. With so much to explore, it's worth getting to know the island before a visit.

Boa Vista is best known for its sea or marine turtle population. Local organisations often help facilitate these beautiful, but sadly increasingly rare, animals lay their eggs on the beaches to help protect the species. July to October is the best chance to see this incredible phenomenon, when several agencies offer turtle-watching tours among other trips to see the beautiful natural surroundings of the island.

As on Sal, the conditions are ideal for water sports with many chances to take advantage of the waves. The bays of Sal Rei, Boa Vista's quaint capital, are protected against the wind by a neighbouring island - creating the perfect conditions for swimming. Surfing, windsurfing and kitesurfing are all available as well as scuba diving and snorkelling. An assortment of ways to explore the coast and underwater depths of Boa Vista.



Turtle-watching



WORLD TRADE CENTER®
ABUJA

Unparalleled Luxury Living



Iconic. Triumphant. Uncompromising. **World Trade Center Abuja**, the most prestigious address in Africa.

Introducing Africa's newest and most prestigious project in Abuja, the capital city of Nigeria. **Tower One Residences** at the World Trade Center, Abuja feature a limited release of luxury homes complete with a service-rich lifestyle that reflects your demand for perfection.

TO SCHEDULE AN APPOINTMENT OR FOR INFORMATION CONTACT

On-site sales office: +234 818 668 6686 or +234 816 000 0440 or visit www.wtcabuja.com



All art renderings are artist's impression only. These materials shall not constitute an offer or solicitation in any State or jurisdiction where prior registration or other legal requirements are required or not fulfilled. Void where prohibited by law. Access to, and use of certain amenities, may be restricted and may be subjected to mandatory fees, membership requirements and/or additional restrictions.

API
AFRICA PROPERTY INVEST
PLATINUM
COLLECTION

Luxury ❁ *Opulence* ❁ *Prestige*

Africa Property Invest Present
The Platinum Collection

A hand selected range of leading luxury properties from inside and outside of Africa, in the most sought after locations across the continent.

Designed to meet the highest international standards and created to meet the needs of the upwardly mobile.

This collection of prestigious developments represent the very best that Africa has to offer

Each carefully selected development has been diligently chosen to showcase pioneering techniques, ground breaking innovations and in some cases world premiere in construction urbanisation.

The Platinum Collection amalgamates the most extravagant developments in the most sought after destinations within Africa, built today for a brighter future.

Membership by invitation only

Developers from all destinations may apply

E.platinum@afriapropertyinvest.com

www.afriapropertyinvest.com



REAL ESTATE INVESTMENT IN NIGERIA

NIGERIA AS A NATION, BY DR FREDERICK B ODUTOLA



Nigeria is the most populous black nation in the world, currently boasting a population of over 178.5 million people, up from 45.2 million in 1960, an increase of 295% over the last 50 years. It ranks 7th in the world population index, only trailing behind China, India, USA, Indonesia, Brazil and Pakistan. However, an increase in population has the subsequent effect of increasing the demand for shelter, which resides within the most important level in the hierarchy of needs, amongst the other basic needs for survival such as food, water, and clothing.

IN THE BEGINNING

In the past, the housing problem faced in Nigeria has been tackled mainly through self-efforts and a small number of communal efforts. With communal efforts here in the sense that a collection of builders with differing expertise would come together in turn, to offer their services free of charge to one another, in order to help build each other's houses. This was not housing on a mass scale as seen in the high-volume housing units Real Estate offers today, people were just building houses to take care of their families. Land was vested in families with ownership being claimed in the traditional sense for the first time as being first in law.

In 1861 for example, Lagos became a British Colony and the land was vested in the Empire, held in trust by the agents of the British Government. By 1963, following on from Nigeria becoming a Republic, three years after independence (1960), the sovereignty of Nigeria as a nation was established. However, it was not until the 1976 Land Use Decree that the government took ownership of the land so that the government could acquire land for the use of the public for the expansion of roads, building airports, and car parks among other uses.

THE STORY TODAY

As a direct result of human migration from various towns and cities to mega cities, Lagos, Abuja, and Port-Harcourt became the most congested places in Nigeria with the attendant housing shortage, struggling to cope with the massive influx of people. The population of Lagos alone was put at around 21 million in 2014. This alone is close to the whole population of neighbouring country Ghana, which stands at 24 million. This congestion has led to unhealthy living conditions in ghettos like Ajegunle, Ibeju-Bariga among others. The government promise of good housing therefore became a near impossible promise to uphold with the influx of people from all over Nigeria into mega cities, this is especially evident in Lagos, where the government has made additional promises of free education up to high school age.

CORPORATE AND INDIVIDUAL EFFORTS IN HOUSING

As it stands today, no amount of investment in real estate for the provision of housing could ever be considered an exercise in futility. The demand for housing is almost insatiable and coupled with the high cost of building materials and workmanship, it becomes too expensive for civil servants (government workers) to be able to afford. It is for this reason that the government is promoting certificates of occupancy to organisations and individuals involved in the development of real estate, who in turn allow people to purchase houses off-plan, depositing while construction goes on and eventually becoming theirs. This is a sort of partnership between consumers and real estate investors gives potential low income buyers another route to home ownership. Mortgage banks want to be of assistance but depositors are always looking for the best interest rates on their money, so these banks depend on government subsidies for housing funds so as to make mortgage loans attractive to consumers.

REAL ESTATE IS THE REAL INVESTMENT

At a point in time in Nigeria, everybody was running after shares as the Stock Exchange was growing rapidly but then came a serious crash. However, real estate investment remains the only stable investment that has always appreciated with time. In all the 36 States in Nigeria, including the Federal Capital Territory, it has dawned on leaders that they can never go wrong with the provision of housing and the demand still outshines the supply, even with the concerted efforts of the government, the corporate bodies and the individual investors. For example in a little Estate known as Iroko Estate in Ibeju Idimu, Lagos State, the plot of land that went for N2.5m. in 2006 now goes for N15m. (600% increase in 10 years). In Crown Estate, Ajah-Lekki, a British investor bought a twin duplex for N40m in 2007, it is now valued at N300m (750% increase in 9 years). After collecting rent of N4m. per annum for 7 years (N28m), receiving another N300m seems like a sound investment.



SEVEN REASONS TO INVEST IN REAL ESTATE IN NIGERIA

1. The demand for housing is so high that the investment has a ready-made market as alternatives are very hard to come by.
2. The cost of materials are comparably very low when laid side by side with the advanced countries. For example cost of building in NY is said to be about 5 times the cost of building same structure in Lagos Nigeria.
3. The cost of labour is another plus for the real estate market in Nigeria. Labour is relatively cheap and this massively reduces the cost of house construction.
4. The tax paid on properties are relatively low, especially in Lagos where you provide all amenities from water to light among others in your house.
5. Nigeria is a country where you can enter and exit business at will without having anything to lose. The environment is incredibly investor-friendly to a large extent.
6. Corporate organisations are also ready to take bulk housing for their staff members as it is easier for a staff bus service to collect the majority of employees from one point to then take them to and from work, and serves as yet another ready-made market.
7. Whether it is Deed of Assignment, or Certificate of Occupancy, consent and documentation is not cumbersome for land in Nigeria and this is a positive selling point for attracting interest in real estate investment.

CONCLUSION

Nigerians are very accommodating people. Do not get dissuaded by the negative western journalism about Nigeria, it is a very warm country where people are their brothers (and sisters') keepers.

Dr. Fred B. Odutola is an attorney-at-law whose interest in real estate dated back to 1978 when he had his first building and within 6 years from then, through investment of income from one on another was able to boast of 8 landed properties. He is therefore writing from a practical experience of an investor in Real Estate.

by **Fred. B. Odutola**



THE ESTATE PROPERTY GUIDE

PEOPLE

UP CLOSE AND PERSONAL

WITH ROB JARRETT CEO OF RESORT GROUP PLC

An interview with Joseph Farodoye, Co-founder Africa Property Invest/ Estate Property Guide

I would like you to imagine the warm sun, the cool breeze and the distant melodic sound of crashing waves. This was the beautiful environment that embraced me in the island of Sal located in the jewel of West Africa's crown, Cape Verde. As fate has it, I was able to meet with one of Cape Verde's most industrious business moguls, Rob Jarrett - An employer of more than 3,500 people in the amazing setting of the Melia Dunas Beach Hotel, which happens to be Africa's largest beach front hotel resort.



What would you attribute to your success?

What would you attribute to your success?

Why Cape Verde?

I'm originally from Leeds, a northern boy born in a council maisonette in a situation where there's very little work available and those sorts of things, so when you're growing up you see a very different side to life.

Has your heritage added to your character?

If you spin a globe and you look at every single continent and you look at the map and you see where the beach-front locations are that are available for investment, then the reality is there is nothing available in the world - If you were to perform a PEST analysis (business measurement tool - Political, Economic, Social and Technical factors), there's

nothing available in the world that gives the rate of return that Cape Verde gives right now this minute, it doesn't exist. Its either war torn, it has problems from a touristic perspective, it has religious problems - Here, none of that exists.

What led you to this conclusion?

Extensive extensive research, we never make a decision unless we've researched everything thoroughly. Cape Verde we researched in a serious way and now we've got what we want. We've got a good position, a good bolt hold in this country and we intend to fully move into other territories as well. So not just one jurisdiction, but Cape Verde has been a big part of what we're doing.



How many years has this project taken?

I'm in my eleventh year to establish the structure and it's been quite a difficult journey because we have to do the political aspect of things as well as the economic side and during that period there was an economic crisis. So the reality is that we've not had it easy, we've been through a rough ride and we need to make sure we continue and every turn in the path we can try to navigate and circumnavigate issues that are causing us problems.

When and where did it all start?

A long time ago I worked in financial services and from the age of sixteen, I am now 41, I've always been working in financial services but primarily in property in the UK primarily. And outside of that Spain, Toronto, Canada, and the UK in a commercial sense and then Cape Verde.

Where were you born?

I'm originally from Leeds, a northern boy born in a council maisonette in a situation where there's very little work available and those sorts of things, so when you're growing up you see a very different side to life.

Has your heritage added to your character?

It is my character it's my heritage it is what it is - In general terms all I wanted to do is either help myself grow or help other people have a good life.

When did you want to become an entrepreneur?

When I was 12 years old I established 2 companies one was a car washing business crazily enough (laughs) and the other one was a business that dealt with gardens and I'd sell that service through my friends in school. I started two businesses and started to earn money and understand that, that was the thing brought about good things in life and that I could excel and more importantly sell. >



What has been your inspiration?

My inspiration was really my heritage; I am more interested in what I leave behind than what I take. My children their children and so on are the most important things and I think that they should have a good start in life so I'm inspired by that.

Are you planning on developing further?

Yes, we have three hotels here on the island of Sal as well as a concept called Bikini Beach which is a rival I would say to Nikki Beach and I'm sure they wouldn't be happy to hear that but it's true. And we have 6 other resorts planned for Boa Vista on the West coast in Santa Monica and then in addition we have, at the request of the Prime Minister two years ago, I've signed a contract with Hilton to build a 200 room hotel which is a largest structure vertically in Cape Verde with Hilton group. And then outside of that we have lots of other opportunities which are the Caribbean, Ibiza, Balearic Islands as well as other areas, our intention is global.

Was it your intention to build the largest resort in Africa?

On the African continent they can take more people, more tourists than any other resort including Sun City in South Africa. So we can take just over 5,000 people.

How will your development differ in Boa Vista?

Well we have more brands because on Sal we have three resorts, Tortuga was opened in 2011 and then we have Dunas and then Llana which is opening shortly this year. In Boa Vista we have 6 resorts all of which will be different brands and we have a flood of interest from the outside market to represent us from a touristic perspective as hotel operators.

Are there any limiting factors for your future developments?

There are definitely logistical problems no question the demand for the location beats the supply of airlift so the quality of bed-nights is not a problem because we've put our best foot forward and invested, it's the investment requirement from the airlines that is the necessity. Having said that, we also have a huge commitment from various companies who can produce the relevant air lift from different jurisdictions to bring people here and we also have a target team with the government working in conjunction with the Resort Group who are going to make sure that that happens.

What makes this a good investment opportunity?

Imagine you invest at a static level your purchase price is what it is and it never changes, you bought what you bought at the price that you bought it - The only thing that increases is the cost of the holiday and therefore your yield increases. So its asset backed and also you have the benefit of the uplift in the cost of holidays throughout the medium to long term... I think it's a no brainer.

What advice would you give to someone starting out?

My advice would be play hard later play smart before, make sure that you work like an absolute animal up until the point of which you've reached success and make sure that you're well planned. If you don't plan for what you're going to do, then what you think is going to happen is not going to happen. It's ok having a dream but to make it a reality the workload is massive - So my advice would be: Get up in the morning and go to sleep late at night and make sure that the vast majority of what you do in between is work.

What are the two key lessons you have learned in

business? Numbers and reputation - in that order. You get your numbers wrong you fail immediately, cash is king so you run out of that, you're finished already. Outside of that reputation is everything.

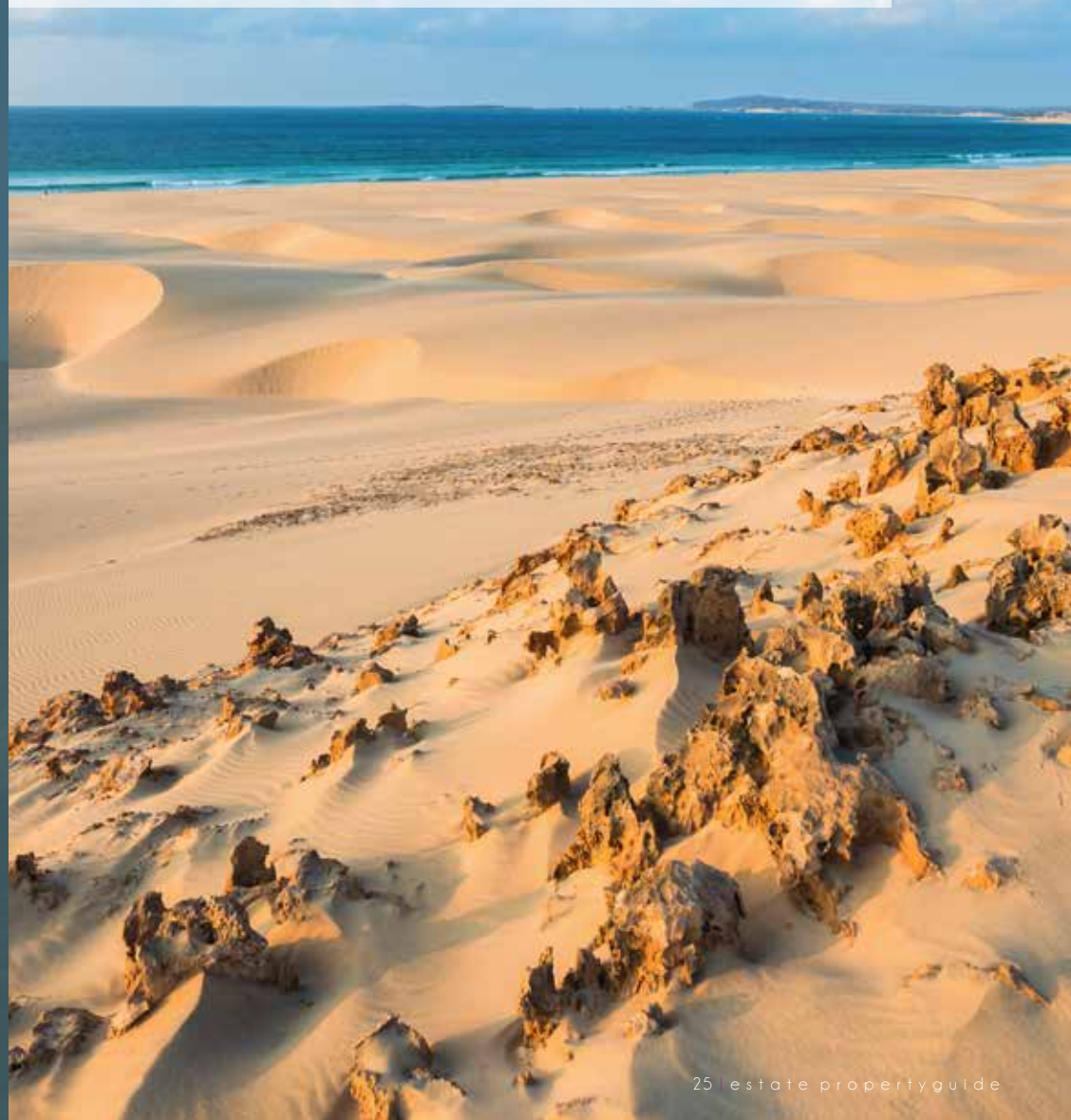


Conclusion:

Upon concluding my interview with Rob Jarrett, my expectations not only of Cape Verde as a country, the investment opportunities available, the beauty and tranquillity of the Melia Dunas, were far exceeded. The insight gained into the making of the Melia Dunas and the meticulous nature of the astute tycoon that is Rob Jarrett left me under no illusions. Everything one can think of has been taken into careful consideration, the plan and scope for Cape Verde as a holiday/ investment destination have been realised, all that is left to advise you, is to experience Africa's largest resort for yourself.

Please log on to the estatepropertyguide.com for the full length interview and more information on Cape Verde.

by Joseph Farodoye Co-Founder of API/The Estate Property Guide



THE TOP 5

ASPIRATIONAL PROFESSIONS/INDUSTRIES IN NIGERIA

AS NIGERIA CONTINUES TO EVOLVE, THE ECONOMY HAS SHIFTED AND OLD PROFESSIONS HAVE BEGUN TO CHANGE

BY MARY T SALAMI

The professions outlined below are quickly becoming the aspirations of both the young and old, partly due to a crash in previously viable professions, and also as a result of the present lucrative nature, and increased awareness of these professions, by a greater number of Nigerians causing them to move up the industrial table of professions in Nigeria

- The current pay-grade of these professions may range from N150,000 to N250,000 Naira monthly. Whether a Medical Doctor that diagnoses and treats illnesses or one in the agricultural profession that cultivates, harvests, and sells food crops, or a musical artist, the average monthly salary falls within N150,000 to N250,000 Naira monthly, except in very rare cases.
- The skill sets required for the professions listed may only slightly vary as there are basic skills necessary to be successful in any profession.



In Nigeria, one could say Agriculture has remained the largest sector of the Nigerian economy by providing employment opportunities for the teeming population, whilst generating employment for around 70% of the Nigerian population. If rural development and greater education of farmers is implemented, it has the potential to strengthen the agricultural sector and create employment opportunities which in turn will bolster the Nigerian economy as a whole.

The current policy direction of the Nigerian Federal government has encouraged farming, which is leading to a shift in the orientation of farming towards research. It has also been observed that the current government pay grade to farmers through the provision of loans and improved processing technology led to efficient use of resources by many farmers in Nigeria.

Given the various programs and policies implemented over the years to raise farmers' efficiency and productivity in food production, it has led policy makers in introducing policy for the improvement of the welfare of farmers, which in turn will give room for the expansion of food production.

Nigerian farming is characterised by a very large number of small holders scattered over a vast expanse of land throughout the country, cooperative organisations have continued to offer the best machinery for reaching the masses of small-scale farmers at the grassroots.

There is an old African saying, "everyone must eat", and Nigerians love their fresh fruit and vegetables. With the decrease in value of the Naira, a lot of people are leaving the white collar jobs and are moving into farming.

The salary grade for farming largely depends on the employer and many other factors such as location, and resources >

TOP 5 ASPIRATIONAL PROFESSIONS/ INDUSTRIES IN NIGERIA

CURRENTLY WITHIN NIGERIA THE TOP 5
ASPIRATIONAL PROFESSIONS ARE;

1. AGRICULTURE
2. MEDICINE
3. MUSIC
4. REAL ESTATE
5. FASHION



The Medical profession is the second aspirational profession in Nigeria, the following skills are required among others;

A. Scientific skills: a good knowledge of science, diagnosis and treatment are important.

B. Communication skills: doctors must be able to communicate effectively with patients to be able to diagnose and treat patients. A knowledge of other languages may be advantageous.

C. Patient care skills: this involves empathy, confidence, respectfulness, thoroughness etc.

The third aspirational profession in Nigeria is in Music, Musical Artist's are among one of the fastest growing professional industries in Nigeria today.

This is based mainly on talent and rhythm and can generate significantly large amounts of money, from performances and endorsements from cooperate bodies.

Sodade Oluwaseun (Saxpriest) is 30 years of age. He started his musical career as a classical musician a began singing in 1996. He is a multi-instrumentalist and plays over 6 instruments with the saxophone being the main instrument. Saxpriest burst into stardom,

becoming famous nationally in the year 2009 due to his participation in a music reality TV show called STAR QUEST which was aired in Nigeria and internationally.

The fourth aspirational professions in Nigeria are split between Real Estate, Manufacturing and the Exportation.

These sectors can be considerably difficult for young jobseekers to get a foothold into, as they are fast becoming saturated and very competitive.

Due to the recent crash of the Oil and Gas industry which was the major source of the country's revenue, other sustainable industries are immediately being explored. Importation of goods and products into Nigeria has also reduced as clothing, paper bags and washing liquids, are now being manufactured in Nigeria on a small scale. Another lucrative and fast growing industry is the Real Estate industry where people buy land wait for its price appreciation and resell or build houses, or office buildings on the land in order to market them for a rental fee.

The fifth aspirational profession in Nigeria is in fashion. The main areas include clothing, shoes, and bags, and also traditional attire using, African print material.

Due to the present economy in Nigeria many middle aged jobseekers have gone into the fashion industry.

AfrikClassik Couture was founded by Okorodudu Mildred Ejio a young 27 years old entrepreneur, based in Lagos. The only girl of her family who sadly lost both her parents at a crucial point of her life, she is a graduate of Mass Communication from the Nigerian Institute of Journalism.

Miss Ejio branched into the Ankara Craft and established AfrikClassik due to her love for beautiful native fabrics and Ankara especially. She learnt the art of craft making in Ghana and brought it back to Nigeria where the public loved it. Her Ankara craft business started officially in February 2015 but she was successfully trading for 3 years. Like any up and coming business woman she started the business from selling hand to hand, moving from place to place until she acquired a chain of customers then managed set up an office of her own.

Today AfrikClassik has grown into a company with over 100 customers and 3 employees. With a mandate to train young adults into becoming future business owners. The young business mogul behind the brand is Okorodudu Mildred Ejio age 27 and she is the sole Founder of AfrikClassik Couture.

Conclusion:

The terrain of employment is in an encouraging state. Although other resources are needed for businesses to thrive, highlighting the fact that human resource is very important as it makes or breaks a business. In Nigeria today so many people want to be employed just to get paid, without effectively bringing any skill or acumen to the table. Fortunately, with Nigeria rapidly becoming the hub for entrepreneurial business men and women within Africa, employees are beginning to view themselves as businesses in their own right and in turn this is having a positive effect on the workforce as a whole.

Mary t. Salami is an Entrepreneur and CEO of a leading recruitment company based in Lagos Nigeria. With over 18 years of international business experience. A former graduate of information science and technology of the university of north London.

by Mary T Salami



CHANGING THE FACE OF BEAUTY^(SERIES)

VOLUME 1

BY ERYCA FREEMANTLE

A fresh start and a clean slate. To make changes and become a better version of yourself, it is important to address your past to allow for a brighter future.

I am Global beauty ambassador and motivational speaker Eryca Freemantle, I have overcome a number of major life challenges including bullying, major bouts of sadness, depression and a devastating accident which left me unable to walk for two years, a badly scarred face and permanent extreme hair loss, amongst many things.

How did I pick myself up and climb up my career ladder? I did this by finding my inner peace and the need to survive and strive. I have always known the only person who could save me was me. It all starts with self-love and determination.

I describe my old feelings of worthlessness and self-destruction and a sense, "that "this was it," I worked hard dealing with my past to accept and embrace what had happened to me, enabling me to move forward. Life was not easy for me or anyone else around me.

A British celebrated name in global makeup and strategic industry intelligence circles. A leading expert on women of all skin tones, skin care and makeup, former advisor on the panel for London College of Fashion (UAL).

My team and I build people's confidence tapping into the inner being, encouraging them to strive for the best and be the best they can be. This can only be achieved by individuals being honest with themselves and endeavour to leave their past behind, no matter how traumatic. This is one of the hardest things that any individual may have to do. This is an integral part of moving forward to excel at everything you want to do in life.



You ask why am I being so open and transparent with you, why am I sharing so much of me? The main reason for this is because at this stage in my life, I intend to give you the best of me and to do that, I too need to be transparent.

I need to share with you my journey where necessary and I believe this will encourage you to understand the back bone of who Eryca Freemantle is and what we represent. We intend to share with you great stories of phenomenal achievers in their chosen professions in the Estate Property Guide.

Now in my 50's, I proclaim that I am the happiest I have ever been. Now qualified to help you achieve your objectives and goals. I share my top tips on how to be the best you can be for the rest of your life.

Your new life begins today. It does not matter how successful we are, we can spend more time and effort to look after ourselves. We must support and empowers others to do the same. I have discovered one thing in life. If and when I need help I will simply ask. Please remember to do the same.

I look forward to bringing something different and new to this wonderful platform giving those within the beauty and wellbeing industry the opportunity to shine and share their knowledge. >



ACKNOWLEDGE AND ACCEPT YOUR LIFE EXPERIENCES BEFORE STARTING TO MAKE CHANGES

is all about making positive changes, but you need to start by acknowledging and accepting your past first in order to understand why and how to make such changes. Change does not happen in a day, it can take years – however there must be a start.

I know only too well that life experiences shape who you are, but I believe that all too often we don't actually deal with resulting issues. Instead we try to avoid them, which I feel is a big mistake.

"You do need to take the most painful journey to acknowledge what's happened and relive your past to understand how you got to this point. If you can't tackle why it happened, you won't know what to do." For example, instead of launching straight into a new beauty look or regime, first understand and accept what is it that you are trying to change and why. "Many people comfort eat when they are stressed or unhappy and without tackling the cause of these feelings." Accepting your past means learning to accept who you are and only once you've dealt with past issues can you move on to make successful changes.

I advise, "To progress in our journey we will sometimes find we take two steps backwards. This is normal and we must not punish

ourselves. We must take one step at a time, cry when we need to and ask for help when we have to.

Making a new you is easy – it's putting it all into action which is difficult, we tend to sit and often wonder how we would be if we had this or if we had that. "Ultimately, if you can understand your past and who you are and then learn to love yourself, you are giving yourself the best head start to success."

Let's work together, to make the difference and create the change needed. Let's start by working on ourselves. Over the coming months we will embark on this new found journey together.

Let's together make the difference needed to make the change.

Until next time.

Eryca Freemantle is a business magnet, Ceo, Global Beauty Ambassador and Motivational Speaker.

by Eryca Freemantle

THE ESTATE PROPERTY GUIDE

CULTURE

BANKING IN NIGERIA

COMPLEXITIES OF AN EMERGING NATION

During the colonial era, banks facilitated the process of exploiting minerals and raw materials in order to develop the manufacturing base of western economies, instead of harnessing and developing the colonies. Independence brought recognition that the role of banks was fundamental to Nigeria's economic growth. However, in order to achieve such an objective it was necessary to redefine the structure of the banks. The indigenisation decree of 1972 (amended in 1977) aimed at empowering Nigerians with shaping a banking system best suited to the Nigerian economic and social environment. Banking was placed under schedule 2 of the decree, thus enabling sixty percent of the shares of banks to be held by Nigerians.

Indigenisation enabled many young Nigerians to acquire banking skills from their foreign banking partners, while at the same time ensuring that the focus of banking activities was in developing the Nigerian economy. However, with loss of control through dilution of ownership, most foreign investors questioned their own ability to achieve their corporate objectives. It was, therefore, not surprising that within ten years of the indigenisation decree most foreign banks sold their interests and left Nigeria. While Nigeria was basking in the euphoria that Nigerians now controlled the formation of capital for industrial growth, our leaders lacked the foresight to realise that Nigerian banks were still a part of the global banking village and therefore had to comply with internationally recognised banking standards, particularly where medium and long term funding was required. In the mid 1980's, many banking licences were issued as a form of political patronage; failing to recognise the seriousness of banking as an engine for economic growth. Most banks diverted their attention to easy profits gained through trading in foreign exchange and the importation of commodities such as milk, sugar, rice etc, rather than focussing on the financing required for the industrial development of the economy. Given the general trend of banking, many of the banks were undercapitalised and lacked stability.



Banks in Nigeria have equally been plagued with the difficulties of 'the matching principle'. In simplistic terms a five-year loan is matched by a five-year deposit. A ninety-day loan is matched by a ninety-day deposit and so on. In Nigeria, the average maturity deposit profile of the banks is below six months. Applying the matching principle implies that the banks are ideally suited to fund short term activities, namely trading. Regrettably, short term trading does not create jobs. The real question becomes whether the banks are really serving the best interests of the country by defining a trading economy as the national imperative. Trading economies tend to accumulate wasting assets, with very little value added and at the same time applying tremendous demands for foreign exchange. They also do not encourage manufacturing and the transfer of technology, neither do they employ labour. Thus, in Nigeria today, high levels of unemployment exist with the concomitant problems of crime and social unrest.

Banks are the engine for economic growth. Therefore, efforts must be made to channel their capabilities in a more positive direction. Banks by their very nature and like all companies, owe their allegiance to their shareholders. Therefore, by their very nature are not prepared to venture into areas that are considered high in risk with low returns. For most Nigerian banks, the enabling environment is hostile: Dwindling revenue from petroleum products, poor infrastructure, epileptic power supply, high interest rates, lack of efficient rail and road systems, poor emphasis on agriculture, high levels of crime, insecurity and political uncertainty to name a few. None of these are peculiar to the country. To the contrary, similar problems are evident worldwide. Nigeria possesses a high degree of able and well qualified personnel and apart from petroleum products, there is an abundance of minerals yet untapped. And a purposeful government taking huge strides in eradicating corrupt practices and encouraging transparency.

Efforts have been made by past regimes to clean up the banking system. By shoring up the capital base of the banks, it was believed that they would become stronger, both in terms of their balance sheets and performance. Equity in banks has always been used to protect a bank against losses or even perceived losses. However, the bank's capital is used largely for its premises and equipment rather than for trading or operational purposes.

Therefore, very little of the Bank's capital can be considered to have a positive impact on the economy looking through the prism of 'value added'. In so far as imbalances exist between the maturities of a bank's liabilities and assets, the deposit profiles of the banks must increase substantially to correct those imbalances with a bias for longer term bank deposits. There must be fiscal policies created by government to support and encourage bank instruments with longer maturities. In this regard, Nigeria can learn from the South African banks. It is noteworthy that South African banks play an important role in providing funds for Nigeria's major projects - particularly in the area of communications.

Banks must be enticed into supporting the key aims of the government. Should the government of the day determine that, say, agriculture is to be given a priority, then banking licences should be granted or recalibrated through mergers to support government efforts. If the precondition to granting a banking licence is that, for example, 80 percent of the bank's loans must be for agricultural purposes, then the onus will be on the bank in question to ensure it can recruit staff with adequate knowledge about agriculture to make a positive impact. Similar criteria can be applied to different sectors of the economy, focussing exclusively on facilities that will benefit that key sector of the economy.

In Nigeria and indeed most emerging economies, ninety-five percent of the banks are commercial banks. As mentioned earlier, by their very nature, they focus on shorter term transactions which imply trade. This can be regarded as part of the colonial legacy. A greater emphasis must be placed on supporting industries, agriculture and low cost housing which require longer term funding. In this regard, more attention can and should be given to Industrial Development Banks, Merchant Banks/ Issuing Houses, Discount Houses, Mortgage Institutions, Agricultural Banks and Private Equity Funds. There equally needs to be a connect with major international financial institutions.





In 1964, the Nigerian Industrial Development Bank (NIDB) was established. Its main aim was to facilitate industrial development within Nigeria. To its credit, the bank attracted such eminent world class investors such as: The International Finance Corporation, Chase International Investment Corporation, Commonwealth Development Finance company, Institution Mobiliare Italiana, Bank of America. To quote Henry Chukwuka Omo (former Controller of Operations at NIDB)

"The international shareholding and membership of the board ensured a high standard of appraisal work and gave NIDB an international status". He went on to say "NIDB was to be the vehicle for the promotion of industries in Nigeria but was mandated to lay emphasis on Nigerian-controlled projects. With government takeover of NIDB, the directors were appointed by government, and the appointment of Managing Directors and executive directors did not take account of professional competence and training needs. The operations of NIDB gradually came to a stage that it could not finance any new projects by 1998. A new industrial bank has been set up in 2002 with a capital of N 2 billion and it is wholly owned by government. Lessons should have been learnt from the ownership structure, board composition and other promotional contributions of the foreign partners. 100 percent government ownership means supervision by incompetent civil servants"

Much has been quoted from the experiences of Henry C. Omo, because his views were and remain pivotal in the direction of banking in Nigeria. Long term

funding, professional appraisals, removal of political influences, diversification from an oil based economy and most importantly, the creation of jobs and specialist training of key personnel. Clearly, the solutions to the banking sector must engage a holistic approach, embracing the political dynamics, the cultural values, and developments within the country, the oil market and many other elements that culminate in affecting the enabling environment.

In Nigeria, the shortage of housing has been challenging for successive governments in the past. The mortgage market remains embryonic. Typically, mortgages in Nigeria are structured between 3 to 7 years. This implies that only the more affluent can afford a mortgage. In the United States, mortgages are typically structured over 15 to 30 years. In certain circumstances US mortgages can be structured up to 40 years. In Japan, mortgages are structured up to 100 years. The longer the tenor of the mortgage the lower the monthly payment plan. Under these circumstances, mortgages can be structured to ensure low income earners can participate in obtaining a mortgage. Today, the mortgage market represents over 40 percent of Japan's Gross Domestic Product. The mortgage market depends heavily on government treasury investment. Commercial mortgage-backed securities form an essential part of the thriving secondary market in the capital market. In order to develop the housing market, government may consider the creation of tax incentives to mortgage companies and subsidies to genuine property development companies. Funding of the

mortgage companies cannot and should not be left solely to government. Privately owned institutions should be encouraged both locally and internationally. Indeed, Nigerians living in the diaspora can actively participate by investing and stimulating the property development market in Nigeria.

In conclusion, the National planners should be allowed to define the strategic direction of the nation's economy; particularly areas that create jobs and the banking system should support those goals. In this regard, the country can benefit from the example of the successful banking systems worldwide. Secondly, while the capital base of the Nigerian banks has been increased in recent years, there is still the need to create fiscal incentives to encourage longer maturing deposit profiles within the banking industry without compromising the financial strength of the banks. This would encourage lending to the industrial sector and sustainable economic growth rather than focussing on a trading economy. The role of the Development banks should be broadened to a more international level and Merchant banks/Issuing houses should be encouraged to actively handle medium and long term securities, and as such, help fill the existing funding gap in the Nigerian financial market. Decisive action needs to be taken now for sustainable economic growth. Nigeria can follow the example of successful economies around the world and establish a banking structure that will encourage economic growth.

by John Chuka Mbanefo

AFRICA INVESTING FROM WITHIN

INVESTING IN YOURSELF

Africa has the largest inhabitable land mass, a land mass on Earth so extensive, you could place China, India, United States, and Europe within her borders. A continent which is a compilation of many African nations, nations that have contributed their cultures and traditions into making Africa...CREATI

A great melting pot or Diaspora of African diversity which even to this day fuels its investment potential not exclusively to its natural resources but from the very cultures and traditions encompassing Africa from religion, education, fashion, and the intellect of its people that has expanded through the ages into a new renaissance of self and investment.

Africa a land that offers and continues to offer itself from its very beginnings... its history. A history, which most of the world relates or is in some way affected by. A history involving religion, a religion built on the spirituality of its people and the constellations of the heavens.

A story mentioned by ancient Greek philosophers such as Diodorus Siculus and Plutarch but hidden, changed, or whispered today in society. A religion that started in a place called Ta Seti a word meaning Land of the Bow, a land older than the first dynasty of Egypt.

Ta Seti was separated into two regions Kemet (Upper and Lower) and Nubia (Upper and Lower), currently known today as Sudan, Egypt, Ethiopia, Kenya, and Uganda. This land held and practiced a religion which existed 1000 years before the entrance Judaism.

The religion of the region was also uniquely similar to parts of modern day Christianity, in which both have one God. The Nubians/Kemets God/father was known as Aset and the son was known as Heru. It almost appears, as if, the religion of Nubia/Kemet was the template and the ideology that has been invested into many religions today. >



Ta Seti existed during a time known as the golden age a time when Africans from different regions, including West African nations, came together to build a thriving civilization containing great religions temples, homes and baths. It introduced writing, agriculture, and unique pottery designs. This civilization held the basic amenities of a city that exist today.

The religious temples were not used solely for worship but as a place of higher learning... universities, that's right, this civilization made an investment to the world with the creation of its first universities. These universities not only educated the Kings and Queens and aristocrats but all the people of the land, it also provided education to the Greeks that travelled there for study. In doing this the land created thinkers of astrology and theology, innovators and craftsmen. The fruits of its labor created calendars from astrology, heated pools and bath from innovations, and intricate buildings to include over 200 pyramids (which believed to outdate those of Egypt) and aristocratic homes from craftsmen. There was even a city named Meroe that was famous for its iron production, it is often called the Birmingham of Europe due to its large industrial prowess.

Sure, your thinking this is all on the East of Africa; however, Africans/ black nation's investment expands across the continent and across the Atlantic Ocean to a place better known today as the Americas.

How is this? You say... via way of Nigeria with the Xi people, who are often misnamed the Olmecs, settled in the country known today as Mexico. This discovery or knowledge is now being shared with the world that blacks/Africans were discovered in ancient Mexico and were some of the very first explorers, another true investment

to the world. Africans along with late explorers of China... yes, and I will say it again... China populated the land together creating a new diversity of people, art, and culture. Today these same two continents are now playing a major part together in improving Africa not changing or colonizing but creating desirable and harmonious investment opportunities stemming from Africa's abundant natural resources.

Natural resources from South Africa comprising of gold, platinum, base metals and coal and it's ranked as the fourth largest diamond producer next to Botswana, Canada, and Russia. Then there are the cash crops of maize, rice, coffee, cocoa, and palm oil of West Africa. The natural gas, oil, and the famous coffee of East Africa and North Africa's valuable resources of petroleum, salt, diamonds, and natural gas. Africa is so rich in resources that an expert from "The Telegraph" mentioned it as the next region to boom. It appears many have taken note of this and have started investing in different funds such as commodities and African ISA funds. Commodity funds are basically investments into commodities such as gold, oil, and live stock. African ISA funds are individual savings accounts with investment/shares from African companies. This is a tax efficient way to save and invest because unlike regular savings accounts in which you taxed ISA, you earn all the investment.

Africa's income is growing not only from its history and natural resources but also property, fashion, and its natural beauty products. In the last 10 years the African property market has grown exponentially. Such companies as Africa Property Invest (API) have largely contributed to this growth. API is building solid quality investment properties within Africa that are not only attracting the people of Africa but those from around the world. >



The fashion industry has been taken by storm with African inspired tribal prints. Today many of the major fashion houses such as Gucci, Marchesa, Versace, Roberto Cavalli, and Vivienne Westwood use inspired print on their catwalks; however, the African designers which have used and lived these designs are practically non-existent or overlooked. This is improving and people are taking note that in order to achieve and receive that authenticity of African fashion you must go to those in whom the spirit of Africa runs deep. There are now well known African designers such as David Tlale from South Africa, Duro Olowu from Nigeria, Appeal by Mae from Nigeria, Yomi Casual from Nigeria, Sika from Ghana and the twins Idyl and Ayaan better known as Mataano from Somalia. Each one of these designers have beautiful collections, high quality designs that literally make you feel the strength, spirit, and unique diversity which is Africa, but we must invest. Invest into them to ensure we receive authenticity of African fashion.

Two other major players of investment are skin and hair products. These products contribute to a billion dollar a year industry globally with Africans being one of the significant facilitators. The skin of black people is known for its beauty and youthfulness, of course melanin plays a major factor but this can also be contributed to many of the natural products used such as mango, shea butter, green tea, and olive oil. Many women as well as men are returning to natural products of their heritage. The Nubian Heritage company uses products that were used by our ancestors, products which allowed us to reveal our natural beauty. Not only are natural products for skin but also our hair. Today with the natural hair movement the beauty industry has struck gold. More and more women not just within Africa but the whole diaspora of black women are returning to what

makes them naturally beautiful their "crown and glory"... their hair. If you check the internet you can now view all the videos referencing natural hair care.

The investments in which the African diaspora have given to the world voluntarily or involuntarily are astronomical. Including the people themselves, whom managed to survive the degradation and hardship of slavery but have still managed to accomplish significant contributions or investments for the world. Advancements in medicine Dr. Charles R Drew, famous for making blood transfusion a reality, Dr. Vivien Theodore Thomas, performed the first successful open heart surgery, Granville T. Woods, whose great advancements in technology of the phone, and Lewis Latimer, invented an important part of the light bulb - the carbon filament.

We invested greatly once and developed thriving civilizations encompassing religion, education, amenities of luxury, and buildings of complexity. We're an intelligent, spiritual, and beautiful people filled with ideas that could improve the world but first we need to motivate one another, assist one another, and invest in ourselves like that of our ancestors.

The knowledge and motivation of one person can make change but that of many can make great change and that's truly a significant investment.

E.O.T.O (Each One Teach One Trust)

by Denice Refael

CHARITY BEGINS AT HOME

AN INTERVIEW WITH
PRINCESS MODUPE
OZOLUA A DESCENDANT
OF THE BENIN KINGDOM



Can we begin commending the right individuals who are making a positive impact in communities and bringing hope to the hopeless. We caught up with an authentic Nigerian Princess a decedent of the Benin Kingdom of Nigeria, making all the difference, exchanging her royal duties for a chance to help the disadvantaged.

Can you tell me about the work your organisation does and what programs they run?

Empower54 is a registered Nigerian and US non-profit organization dedicated to providing desperately needed humanitarian assistance such as medical missions, hunger eradication, educational, women/girl empowerment and refugee programs to underprivileged Africans.

Founded in 2003, Empower54 was active in Africa as Body Enhancement Foundation (BEARS, Body Enhancement Annual Re-constructive Surgery). Some of our out-reach programs include the donation of clothing and toys to underprivileged Africans both in remote communities and refugee camps. His Emeritus Archbishop Desmond Tutu is our Patron.

What differentiates Empower54 from other philanthropic organisation?

Our motto is "Restoring hope". Based on that, we have a track record of going into very remote communities, including high-risk places, in order to help those that have given up hope. Not a lot of charity organizations do that due to security and accessibility challenges, but we do.

What would you say your beneficiaries would say is the best thing about your organisation?

Our dedication. Our various teams are made of professionals with different specialties and obligations, despite that, we all put in our time, effort and resources to help those we set out to help. We spend long hours daily without food or water in the blazing sun doing outreach programs. Our attitude isn't that we are doing the beneficiaries a favour; but we are honoured to be of service to them.

What experiences have you had that help you relate to some of the causes you are involved in?

None. I come from a very privileged Royal family, haven't experienced any type of deformity nor know anyone that has; but I don't have to in order to have empathy for others.

What is your motivation for doing what you do?

My motivation is knowing I'm privileged to be used as an instrument in God's hands to help others. Those that have known me as a child are not surprised at my commitment to philanthropy because I have always been a very compassionate person.

In 2001 when I pioneered cosmetic surgery in West Africa, I was only 27 years old. At that time, I simply thought I was coming to invest money in my home country, Nigeria. In 2003, a couple came to my office in need of reconstructive surgery for the wife that had some deformities due to a fire accident.

They narrated how they had made many un-successful appeals to high net worth individuals and their state government to raise funds for her surgery, and I was very disturbed by this. I couldn't understand why no one would help her despite her obvious deformities.

They then asked if I would take it upon myself to help people like them because they are voiceless. I immediately agreed. I swear that was the turning point. They thanked me, left my office and I never saw them again. From that point on, I have used my financial and human resources to make sure I help those that have given up hope.

There are many people that wish they could do what I do, but for one reason or the other, they can't. I am sincerely honoured that God found me worthy to be used to help others in different ways because Empower54 and I are instruments in HIS hands and that's a privilege that can't be bought with money.

What are your goals for the next three to five years?

For Empower54, we will have the right partners globally working with us to ensure sustainability and success in all our endeavours. My different businesses will be running efficiently without me, that will enable me spend more time doing what I love most, which is charity work.

What priorities will help you achieve them?

No organization can function without the right partners for continuous funding and staff/volunteers that share the organizations beliefs and passion. We have prioritized finding the right partners, being creative in methods of fundraising, and inviting like minds to become stakeholders. >



What is the hardest decision your organisation has ever had to make and how did you evaluate the trade-off involved?

Unfortunately, the hardest decision we've made didn't happen once; we continuously make them when we conduct our free medical missions.

This is when we determine what patients will receive free medical care over others. Unfortunately, I play a major role in that process and it's extremely difficult to tell people in desperate need of reconstructive surgeries that for various reasons, such as their deformities require multiple surgeries to achieve the desired result, so we can't treat them now, or they are not good candidates for their procedures because the results of their pre-surgical examination shows them as surgical risks, etc.

Unfortunately, there are no trade-offs to telling dashing peoples hopes, but we try to comfort ourselves that we help those that we can.

What is the most challenging situation you have been in when fundraising for your charity?

Unfortunately, fundraising in Nigeria is only successful when it's politically motivated because the donors are stakeholders or seeking favour from the politicians/government involved. Fundraising for good old genuine charity causes in Nigeria? Forget it!

The same people that say they don't have money to donate because the "economy is bad" will be the ones doling out millions of Naira to politicians. Don't get me wrong, as a businesswoman, I get supporting one's interests; but I also expect people to create a balance by also helping the underprivileged.

That's why we have decided to focus fundraising efforts in the US. As a US registered non-profit, we have a 501(c)(3)/tax exempt status, meaning individuals and organizations that donate to us get tax deductions on their taxes.

Considering there are many organizations with great causes and we are all asking the same people for donations, we have to be creative in our strategy to get donations; this led to the creations of Empower54's Annual African Art Charity Gala. During this event, we showcase and auction African arts to support our humanitarian activities in Africa.

Our maiden charity gala is coming up on April 30th 2016 in Atlanta, GA and it's in partnership with the City of Atlanta. >

Since February 2015, our "Rise Above Terror" campaign commenced rehabilitating hundreds of women and children in refugee camps by empowering the women with monies to start businesses, created schools at the IDP camps for the children and commenced rebuilding schools destroyed by Boko Haram in North East Nigeria.

Proceeds from the art auction in Atlanta goes towards establishing schools with playgrounds in refugee camps and rehabilitation of schools destroyed by Boko Haram in North East Nigeria. We will be auctioning stunning African paintings and breathtaking handicrafts representing the Kings, Queens, traditions, and rich history of the legendary ancient Benin Kingdom (Edo State, Nigeria).

In addition to our Patron, His Emeritus Archbishop Desmond Tutu lending his voice to support our "Rise Above Terror" campaign, Hollywood actress/humanitarian, Kat Graham, who features in the popular series "Vampire Diaries" has joined to support our cause.

Other partners for the event include the Borno State Government (Nigeria), the Andrew Young Foundation, Besharat Gallery, Africa Atlanta, Body Enhancement Ltd, The Nigeria Consulate General (Atlanta), and Fox5 tv.

I am very excited about this event but also very anxious. There is so much at stake. We sincerely need people to support us by buying paintings and art works. They can either attend or bid via our website www.empower54.org

If you could sum up the impact and legacy you want your charity to leave, what would they be in three words?

Genuine, dedicated and impactful.

What frustrates you the most about what you do?

People's inability to understand that you can genuinely help others without expecting a pound of flesh in return.

Describe the feeling you get when you have seen the results of your work in the people that you have helped?

In spite of thirteen years spent helping thousands of the underprivileged, I know I haven't scratched the surface when it comes to how much more I can contribute towards humanity.

Helping disadvantaged people is my calling because it comes naturally to me. Many people go through life not knowing what their true purpose is. Despite all the material comfort and accomplishments they have, they still feel empty.

For me, I am simply living my life to the fullest. I'm fulfilled and doing just what I am created to do.

If I were to die today, my only regrets would be that I didn't live long enough to see my son get married and my grandchildren; other than that, when I do pass away (hopefully not any time soon, because I still have so much more to offer the world) I will die knowing I've done the best with my life as I possibly could. That is the feeling I live with daily.

HIGHLIGHTS FROM EMPOWER54'S ANNUAL AFRICAN ART CHARITY GALA



THE TRUE IMPACT OF AFRICAN FASHION WEEKS

BY PAOLA AUDREY NDENGUE



AS JOHANNESBURG'S 2016 FASHION WEEK JUST KICKED OFF AND A FEW WEEKS AFTER PARIS'S FALL/WINTER 2016-2017 FASHION SHOWS ENDED, PAOLA AUDREY TAKES A LOOK AT THE TRUE IMPACT OF FASHION WEEKS IN AFRICA

Major fashion weeks are often referred to as a "circus" and so, for a number of reasons. First, you have the shows themselves: beautiful (or sometimes not so beautiful) clothes shown on walking hangers. Here a bit of organza, there a long black skirt symbolizing the state of womanhood in a man's world (according to the designer, at least). This whole scenery would be incomplete without the loud soundtrack and the "Ahh" and "Oh" whispered by the guests after every model steps on the runway. Then you have the Pre-show: celebrities arriving in their "Sunday bests" (provided most of the time by the brand who invited them) and the various fashion industry squads (editors, mostly) always pretending not to see the photographers they (also) came to feed.

These various parts of the circus seemed to somehow always blend in the middle of chaos but that was until... the internet arrived and did what it does best: disrupt.

From a private exhibition for a happy few, fashion shows have progressively become mainstream happening events. Through the unavoidable "Selfie culture" and the rise of fashion blogging, the world of luxury was facing one essential and maybe lethal question: "should we follow the trend or stick to traditions?"

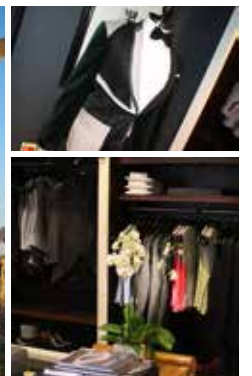
Chanel, for instance, waited until 2015 before venturing for the very first time into E-commerce through selling eyewear online. Of course, digital boutiques selling counterfeited products didn't help in convincing the French couture house it was time to embrace modernity, but still. The real and deep dilemma these legendary brands have

to deal with goes beyond a certain image or etiquette to maintain. It's all about finding a balance in moving forward while acknowledging a sometimes century-long heritage. Looking at the bigger picture, one should understand how hard and tricky it can be to go from dictating trends to chasing after them.

The disruptive nature of the web mentioned above truly came with its blessings and curses. In a world where we usually bought items showcased half a year earlier, online outlets such as Moda Operandi made it easier to reduce the wait. Whereas before we had to read fashion magazine reviews to evaluate the quality (whatever the definition we give to it) of a collection, nowadays you, me, anyone can be a fashion critic... thanks to the few seconds between when a look goes down a runway and when it lands on your Facebook feed or Instagram homepage. If brands such as

Burberry or BALMAIN clearly jumped into it, the "See Now, Like Now, Buy Now" era is not always fun or profitable for everyone. This has been leading to several fashion critics wondering if fashion weeks (in their current form) are still necessary. Forbidding guests to take pictures during the shows or maintaining a very exclusive access to the collections as Tom Ford does, appear more like desperate measures than real solutions. Now that the circus seem to be overwhelmed by itself, what is the point in keeping up with it? If the bubble has truly burst, isn't it time to rethink and more importantly, reshape what used to be a key-piece to an entire system?

While the western part of the fashion cosmos is still seeking for a way out, the African one is still asking "where and how should we start", or almost. For the past decade, fashion weeks have been popping up throughout African capitals. In the heels of the "Africa is rising" narrative, all of a sudden, it somehow became a thing to plan fashion shows with the promise of "promoting local designers". Does the African continent have a functioning textile "industry" (other than exceptions such as South Africa, Morocco or Ethiopia)? Do we have a network of professional buyers scouting the next it-designer from Africa? Do we have fashion critic powerhouses with both a technical and commercial knowledge of the local fashion landscape? The answers to these various questions seem easy but think again: why would we be planning fashion weeks the way the industrialized world does if we don't share the same business environment? On the value chain, fashion presentations are the bottom of the ecosystem, they are the finishing touch and the visible iceberg. Unfortunately, conceiving them as stand-alone parties does everything but help the local designers. >



If the Mercedes-Benz Johannesburg Fashion Week makes sense because of the formalization of the south African market, or the Lagos Fashion & Design Week draws attention thanks to the popularity of the "Buy Nigerian" pop culture (even out of its borders), some fashion weeks in Africa have turned into quite a mockery. Planned as an excuse to collect money from event-goers, some of those shows labeling themselves as fashion celebrations are actually events for an elite made of notorious trophy wives and socialites on the look for some self-promotion.

On the behalf of their organizers, yes, one should recognize the original fashion weeks also used to be for that type of clientele but here was the difference: those women would buy or pre-order after the shows they were attending.

They were directly supporting the designers, stepping out of the average fashion spectator's passive behavior. They would pay attention to the garments, would question the fabrics and eventually, ask for changes on the go. This can hardly happen when a fashion show is staged in between a music performance, a comedy skit and a dinner.

That is what happened to a designer from Ivory Coast who didn't want his name revealed. As the crowd was leaving the venue of a popular fashion festival in Abidjan some weeks ago, he seemed disappointed and even angry as he was packing his cocktail dresses backstage. "The organizers told me I would have the opportunity to discuss with the VIP guests to promote my clothes, but it never happened! What did I come here for, then? Why did I pay a participation fee to have a runway show if people are not even watching?". For the organizers, the event was a total success as the venue was packed, which implies a significant profit was made since the entrance fee was far from being free.

Given the current state of the apparel manufacturing industry and ready-to-wear distribution in the majority of African markets, maybe it's about time, as in the west, we rethink the accuracy of our fashion system. And in the process, may we also take a look at the borderline absurd situations we end up into as we're trying to keep up with international trends. In fact, do we need to name "Fall/Winter" collections in Senegal or Kenya when these seasons don't match the local weather? Do we

need to shoot lookbooks when we can barely produce 10 samples for each featured look? Is the average African audience aware enough of the difference between a tailor and a designer? Between a clothing line and a brand?

Of course, the goal is not to wait for a perfectly mature market to emerge before we can officially do things "the right way". We, lovers of all things fashion in (and by) Africa, have to make it a collective effort towards progress and to make it happen, we need to create platforms for those trying their best. But in the same way Africa took a shortcut during the telecommunications revolution and even appeared at some point ahead of the West (in the Mobile Money department for example), we have to learn from the mistakes of those we are supposedly late to catch up with.

by Paola Audrey Ndengue

THE ESTATE PROPERTY GUIDE



As more tourists wake up to the delights of Cape Verde, MELIÃ Dunas Beach Resort & Spa is only too happy to greet them



Just 500 kilometres off the coast of West Africa, the Atlantic isles of Cape Verde have been dubbed the African Caribbean. While they're still fairly new to the holiday circuit, their out-of-this-world beaches, first class holiday accommodation and lively surf mean they're quickly making a name for sun-seekers the world over.

Cape Verde's most popular island is the cosmopolitan Sal Island, known for its striking, lunar-like landscape. It's dotted with colourful, cobbled towns like Santa Maria on the southern shores, where you'll find surf shops, traditional restaurants and a pretty square lined with al fresco cafés. The main attraction is the beach, which stretches along eight kilometres.

There are plenty more in the way of beaches over on Boa Vista, which translates as 'beautiful view'. The sands here stretch out across the coastline for 55 kilometres and easily rival those in the Caribbean.

All over Cape Verde, a melting pot of cultures adds interest and colour. The Portuguese originally discovered Cape Verde, so there's a mixture of African, Brazilian and Portuguese influences. You'll see it in the island's music, fashion and – perhaps most clearly – the food.

Ideal location

It is for all these reasons that The Resort Group settled on Cape Verde as the ideal location for a range of first class holiday hotels and resorts. Each offers investors the perfect balance of security and return, making them a highly rewarding property investment. Rob Jarrett, CEO of the Resort Group explains his decision. 'It was to capitalise on Cape Verde's natural beauty, sensational beaches and friendly people, and put the islands firmly on the tourist map. Cape Verde also showed welcome political stability, consistent growth in land values and a sustained level of government investment.'

It's no surprise that Cape Verde is earning a reputation as one of the world's hottest property investment locations. The World Travel & Tourism Council placed Cape Verde 10th in the top 50 holiday hotspots after visitor numbers increased by 268% between 2000 and 2013.

High demand

This boom is creating high demand for property from private villas right through to beachfront holiday resorts. 'The great thing about Cape Verde is that there isn't room for overdevelopment in the future,' continued The Resort Group CEO Rob Jarrett. 'It means it won't lose its original



Voted number 1
Hotel in Santa Maria



7th Best Hotel Resort
in the World 2015



charm and appeal. Cape Verde is well protected because the government has strict legislation in place that only allows low level and low-density projects to proceed. This protects the look and feel of the Islands, and also restricts the number of properties that can be built. A similar principle is applied to the land in Cape Verde, which means that much of it is protected and cannot be sold to developers.'

The size of the Cape Verde also gives a feeling of exclusivity. It's a safe country, with a low crime rate, and always has exceptional weather. Unlike some countries, Cape Verde doesn't really have a low season (tourists enjoy temperatures of over 25 degrees all year round), which makes it an attractive holiday destination any time of the year.

It continues to rise in popularity; The Resort Group has already completed two developments in Cape Verde, with more in construction. Following MELIÃ Tortuga Beach Resort, which opened in May 2011 (and has been voted Cape Verde's Leading Hotel for four consecutive years), MELIÃ Dunas Beach Resort & Spa opened in November 2014. Voted the number one hotel in Santa Maria on TripAdvisor, as well as winning several 2015 Hotel of the Year awards MELIÃ Dunas Beach Resort & Spa is ranked an impressive 7th Best Hotel Resort in the World 2015.

Style and quality

The largest hotel resort on the African continent, MELIÃ Dunas Beach Resort & Spa is beautiful inside and out. Every aspect of the development oozes style and quality and is finished to the highest specification. It boasts 1,252 hotel rooms, apartments and villas, five swimming pools and a waterpark as well as 14 bars, six themed restaurants, an YHI Spa and hairdressing salon.

The tone was set at the hotel's glittering launch event in Sal. Hundreds of people, from property investors and sales agents to partners involved in the construction, enjoyed getting a first glimpse into the five-star, all-inclusive resort. The Resort Group's Chairman Rob Jarrett took to the stage to speak about the development of MELIÃ Dunas Beach Resort & Spa and its role in boosting tourism in Cape Verde.

First class

Cape Verdean Prime Minister, Jose Maria Neves, applauded The Resort Group for its work in Cape Verde. At MELIÃ Dunas Beach Resort & Spa's launch event in October 2014, he said: 'Allow me to congratulate The Resort Group for its performance in Cape Verde. For its cooperation, attitude and approach, and for the permanent search for shared solutions so that we can continue to grow. Congratulations, Robert, and a very, very good job!'

MELIÃ
DUNAS
CAPE VERDE

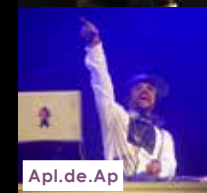
THE
RESORT
GROUP
PLC

The stars come out

MELIÃ Dunas Beach Resort & Spa's opening ceremony was followed by an unforgettable party, with guests seeing a colourful mix of entertainers perform on the beach. The line-up included headline acts Tinie Tempah, Miss Dynamite, Artful Dodger, Black Eyed Peas' Apl.de.Ap, Britain's Got Talent's violinist Lettice Rowbotham and a cappella group The Magnets. A host of celebrities have since visited the resort such as Rio Ferdinand, Katie Price and an array of Coronation Street stars.



Tinie Tempah



Apl.de.Ap

'MELIÃ Dunas Beach Resort & Spa is the biggest accomplishment we have made as a group,' added Rob Jarrett. 'Our partner Meliã has been instrumental throughout the development, ensuring the guest experience will be first class and the touristic flow can continue in this beautiful country. The Cape Verde government has been highly cooperative and, as a result, we have formed a fantastic working relationship with them. By working with the highest quality partners, we have been able to create beautifully designed properties for holidaymakers and those who are looking to find their perfect investment property.'



Cape Verde doesn't really have a low season (tourists enjoy temperatures of over 25 degrees all year round), which makes it an attractive holiday destination any time of the year



YHI Spa



Kids waterpark

A PICTURE OF HEALTH BY UYAI AKPAN

IN MANY WAYS, THERE ARE VARIOUS ASPECTS OF OUR LIVES THAT CAN BE WEIGHED BY A DEGREE OF TANGIBLE AND INTANGIBLE MEASURABLES

In many ways, there are various aspects of our lives that can be weighed by a degree of tangible and intangible measurables. Success, being financially stable, fulfilling relationships and the list could potentially go on.

But how do we measure good health, are the very measures themselves healthy enough, and who or what determines what constitutes as 'healthy' for us? In all honesty, the only source qualified to determine the true state of our health are the very cells that dutifully perform every single task of building, cleansing and maintaining our bodies.

For many of us, a tight set of abs, a small waist, clear soft and vibrant skin, a healthy head of hair and bundles of energy denote an above average level of good health. But did you know, it is quite possible to have all of these things and still be quite unhealthy when viewed on a cellular level. For those of you who are unfamiliar with cellular level health, in a few words it simply means the degree to which a cell that is well nourished can perform its primary function without obstruction.

Our bodies were designed to function at optimum levels, self-regulating allowing peak performance and self-healing. Ultimately, being unhealthy on a cellular level is the result of obstructing that process which would have resulted in a naturally healthy body.

So the essence of returning to good health or even maintaining it, is in reality a lot easier in practical terms than many would have us believe. The basis is more about removing the very things that behave as an obstruction inside the body. Starting with the things that we consume, and branching out to the external things that can have a direct impact on the internal workings of our bodies.

The great body, youthful skin full of elasticity, bountiful locks and energy levels that would resemble the teen-aged 'you', has nothing in comparison to a body completely free to build, cleanse and maintain itself. So don't spend another minute wishing for the days of old, or wishing that attaining true health were easier, because you are already healthy, just wish you were better.

Better equipped to identify the obstructive habits you have acquired that hinder your body from retaining its youthful healthy state, and more importantly, better readied to remove them.

The question is, can we identify some of the things that we are doing or consuming that are stopping us from enjoying a genuinely healthy state of existence?

In this day and age, this question might prompt us into a vigorous Google search, as though Google knows the inner workings of your unique and very specific cellular make-up. Unfortunately (or maybe, not so unfortunately) Google doesn't have those answers, so I would encourage a more holistic look into 'yourself'. Your body, your nutritional needs, your cells deficiencies or obstructions and begin your journey towards better health there.

You may discover that this will begin to have a positive knock on affect in other areas of your life. Something is either building you up or breaking you down, taking you higher or helping to assist your regression. In the same way your eating habits are either adding nutrition to your cells and invigorating them with their innate life force or the food we eat is extracting from our existing life force.

Imagine on a daily basis you provided yourself with a diet that was prepared by a culinary connoisseur, with only organic produce, at optimal temperatures, served on the finest china, in the most beautiful peaceful surroundings, eaten only at the most favorable times. There would still be huge potential to fall short of great health on a cellular level. And the reason for this is very simple, because living cells need living foods in order to preserve, renew or generate more life within them.

[Join us in our next edition](#)



TRAVEL

TOURISM POTENTIAL IN NIGERIA

OUTLINING THE OVERLOOKED AREAS IN NIGERIA THAT BOTH DIASPORA AND TOURISTS CAN ENJOY. BY AMANDA MESHIDA-BANJO

Nigeria is not a holiday destination. Nonetheless it has a burgeoning economy drawing businesses from across the globe in search of new opportunity to the country, thus giving rise to the potential for tourism.



Amanda Meshida-Banjo CEO of Pink Allamanda, a tourism consultancy firm



An open mind and sense of adventure will get you far in Nigeria. Lagos has emerged the epicenter for business. Any problems faced, such as traffic, lack of power or fuel shortages never seem to dampen the entrepreneurial spirit of Nigerians to make money, have fun and enjoy life. Nigeria seems to have a way to captivate people. Many have come to work and never left.

Suzanne Wenger, a Swiss National, was one such captivated by Nigeria when she came to the country during the early 1950's. She was intrigued by traditional Yoruba religion and became an "Adun Orisa", High Priestess, of Ifa culture. She lived in the Oshogbo Forest where she practiced her newfound beliefs, and her art, instigating an art movement termed "the Oshogbo school". The Oshogbo forest became an UNESCO World Heritage Site in 2005.



OUR LIST OF PLACES TO EXPLORE IN NIGERIA:

The Oshogbo Grove forest:

Is about 250 km outside Lagos, in Osun state. Although it is a long drive (3 hours), a round trip can be done in a day. However for overnight stays the famous artist Nike Davies-Okundaye has a guesthouse in Oshogbo, which can accommodate small groups of visitors.

The Osun-Oshogbo festival:

Is a two-week festival held within the same forest during August, to honor the goddess Osun. It attracts up to 100,000 visitors. It is essential to plan ahead when visiting.

Abraka River Resort:

Is located along the stunning River Ethiope, in Warri Delta state. The water is crystal clear and refreshing to swim in. The best place to experience this is at Marcathy Beach, a white sand beach created by the owners of the Gordon River Resort. Early morning swims are fabulous and the best way to explore the river is by canoe.

Abraka Polo and Turf Club:

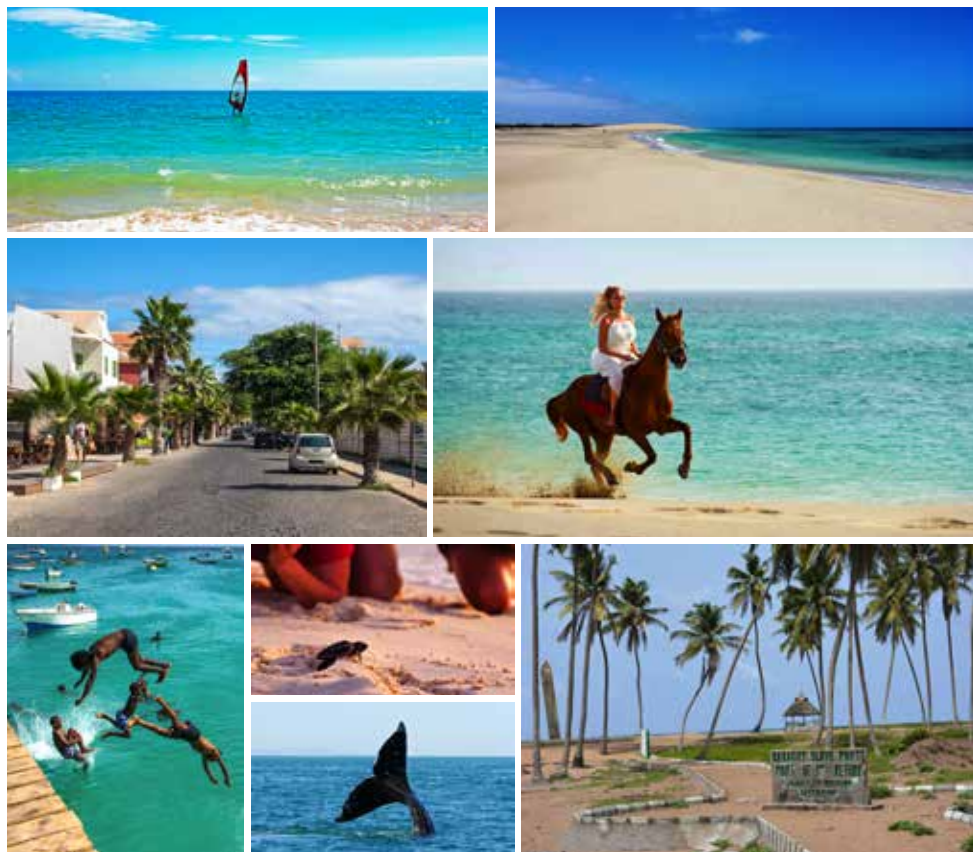
The Club has a polo field, 9-hole golf course, and a limited number of luxury chalets to rent. There is also a wooden boardwalk leading through dense forest to a bathing platform on the bank of the River Ethiope.

Obudu Ranch, Calabar State:

Is located on the Obudu plateau 1,716 meters above sea level close to the border with Cameroon. Breathtaking views, cable cars and the wind will delight you.

The Pandrillus Project:

Also in Calabar State, has two locations for the conservation of endangered species. These projects, known as The Drill Monkey Ranch and The Afi Wildlife Sanctuary, provide an opportunity to experience fascinating and rare conservation projects in Nigeria.



Drill Monkey Ranch:

Is a 4-hour drive from Calabar City. Peter Jenkins and Liza Gadsby set up a rehabilitation center for the endangered Nigerian drill monkey. The ranch cares for orphaned monkeys whose mothers have been killed for their meat. It has had over 250 births the most successful breeding program of Drill monkeys in captivity in the world. Producing the only known birth of twins in this species. Visitors and school children are welcome.

The Afi Wildlife Sanctuary:

Is home to the "Nigerian Big Three". The endangered gorilla, drill monkey and chimpanzee. In 2000, Jenkins and Gadsby worked closely with the Cross River government to secure the area for conservation, now a designated wildlife sanctuary. The only ecotourism attraction in Nigeria, providing six log cabins to rent to visitors.

Abuja Hash: Takes you on a jog around the nations capital, Abuja. It is an excellent way to see the city.

Lake Jabi: Is the ideal place for a picnic, a walk or a jog.

Bwari Pottery Village:

Abuja is located adjacent to the Nigerian Law School and is worth a visit for locally made pottery. Pottery can be purchased on site or from the Embassy of Ecuador in Abuja.

Gurara Falls:

Is situated about an hours drive out of Abuja. The falls are best seen in the Rainy season when the water level is higher.

Kajure Castle Kaduna:

About a 2-hour drive from Kaduna, is the most unusual sight. A European castle built by an eccentric German in the 1980's. The entire castle can be rented for weekends.

Ikogosi warm water springs:

Located in Ado Ekiti has two springs - a warm water spring and a cold - water spring. The convergence of the springs is evident where the cold and hot waters mix.

DESTINATION LAGOS

Badagry:

On the western end of Lagos State is a two-hour drive out of Lagos where the chilling reality of the slave trade awaits the visitor. Everyone should visit at least once but an early start to beat the traffic is necessary.

Beaches:

In Lagos are mostly accessible by road. However, as the saying goes the "excitement lies outside your comfort zone", so take a boat to Tarkwa Bay or visit the POP Beach Club or Inagbe Grand Resort on Ilashe beaches. If this doesn't suit you, a kayak can be rented to paddle the creek.

Freedom Park:

The old Colonial prison you can visit and see the arrangement of cells. Music Shows and Plays often hold there.

Lekki Conservation Centre:

Is a 21-year-old conservation center covering 78 hectares of forest. You can see monkeys, crocodiles, snakes, and monitor lizards. The amazing Canopy-walk recently constructed at 401 meters long is the longest in Africa.

Lufasi Park:

Is an urban forest animal sanctuary initiative situated in Lekki. It has facilities for abandoned animals, and protects endangered Ekki trees.

Lakowe Golf Club Lekki:

Is newly developed golf and residential estate. It is possible to visit on a "pay and play" basis if you like golf.

Art Galleries:

Are a great place to discover Nigeria's phenomenal artists - Peju Alatise, Victor Ehikamenor, Bruce Onobrakpaye, Yusuf Grillo, Victor Ekpuk, George Edozien, Ben Osaghae and Rom Isichei at these galleries:- Omenka Gallery, Nike Art Gallery, Rele Museum, Red door Gallery, African Art Foundation, Centre for Contemporary Art, Nimbus

Gallery, Artists Foundation, National Museum Onikan, Kalakuta Museum, Art 21

Music Trail:

In Nigeria is vast- Old music styles have merged with new forms to produce a vast array of Nigerian musicians. Constant is Afrobeat, the original Fela Kuti sound prevails, and his heirs. See Femi Kuti at his Afrika shrine every Thursday and Sunday and Atropolitan vibes on the third Friday of every month.

Hotels are good place to socialise :

they provide a safe environment

The Wheatbaker Hotel: Because it supports art through hosting exhibitions or displaying artwork by local artists. They also have a dedicated Art Curator.

The George Hotel: Speaks quiet sophistication for those who want to sit by the pool.

The Eko Hotel: For the view, the pool and the outside places to sit and eat.

Bogobiri House: For its eclectic music night's, and being full of fun.

M-gallery House: For quiet sophistication and good food.

Radisson Blu: Has a great terrace by the pool overlooking the creek.

Federal Palace: Has cool spaces indoors to sit forever, escaping the traffic and have coffee.

Epe Resort: Far from the crowd.

Maison Fahrenheit: For the roof terrace.

by Amanda Meshida-Banjio

For more information on the best places to visit in Nigeria contact travel@estatepropertyguide.co.uk



The Estate Advisory Board



The Estate Property Guide has a high standard of excellence as we believe luxury, has no limitation.

It is with this, that we have hand selected some of the leading minds and personalities across Africa and Europe to guide the direction and position the rise of the Estate Property Guide.



Dame Julie Coker

Honourable 1st lady of Television Broadcasting
in Africa (Nigeria)

John Mbanefo

Retired Senior Banker

Prince Dapo Adelegan

President British Nigerian
Chamber of Commerce

Alan Davies

CEO of James Cubitt Architects

Cecil Osakwe

Chairman of CEO Group

Mark Lewis

CEO Bravig (Brand Vision Global)

Muyiwa Olurawaju

Broadcaster/ Singer / TV Personality

Meyiwa Lori-Ogbebor

CEO/Vice Chairman Rita Lori Hotels

Eryca Freemantle

Global Beauty Ambassador

Email: info@estatepropertyguide.com

Berkeley Square House, Berkeley Square, London W1J 6BD

OUR CHILDREN ARE AWASH IN A SEA OF DATA

BY JEFF BARNES

Jared Diamond, a well-known biologist and anthropologist tells a story, about a tribe in New Guinea, that experienced a major hurricane. This hurricane was devastating to the island. During this event the sea came ashore and wiped out most of the tribe's homes and crops. The tribe had an oral history tradition, where information was passed down from generation, to generation.

In the aftermath of the hurricane, the tribe faced starvation, because they hadn't harvested their crops yet, and they didn't know what wild plants were safe to eat. But in that village, was a woman in her late eighties, who remembered, that when she was a little girl, they had experienced a similar hurricane. She remembered, which plants were safe to eat.

She was able to save the tribe, because she was a subject matter expert. More importantly, she was a subject matter expert, with the right information, at the right time, when it could do the most good for her people.



Here we see a concrete example of the importance of data. Here is a time when life and death, depended on the knowledge that only existed in the head of one old woman. She was highly revered by her tribesmen. Not because of her age, but because of her knowledge. Not because of their emotional attachment to her, but their realization that she was vital to the survival of her descendants and neighbors. She was a genuine treasure, deserving of admiration, adoration and emulation. I imagine that if she had tried to tell her younger tribesmen, about her knowledge of plants and herbs, before the hurricane, they might have listened to her politely, but they might not have understood the critical importance of the data she was passing on to them.

In our current society, the bulk of our historical and operational information, and data does not reside, in the heads of our older citizens, but instead resides in our libraries, our databases and of course, the ever-present Internet. But as you know, those sources are only as valuable as our ability to retrieve the right information, at the right time, in the right format, when it can do the most good.

Now, don't get me wrong, our older citizens have a wealth of information, skills and dispositions that they are willing to share. The thing is we have

relegated them to the sidelines and do not revere them in quite the same way our traditional societies treat their older members. Our children do not see our elders in quite the same way that traditional societies see theirs. This attitude shouldn't come as a great surprise but it should however, be of great concern.

You see, our children are awash in a sea of data that gets deeper and wider every day, and they may not fully understand the critical importance of being able to retrieve it, in a meaningful way, when it can do the most good.

So how can we help them? Are we the subject matter experts? Are we the old lady? Are we the ones that will help them survive the hurricane of social, political and educational challenges that they will experience?

Well, the answer is both yes and no. The answer is no because from a pure information perspective, they have access to much more information on edible plants than the old lady ever did. Not only can they find out information on edible plants but they can determine how to find shelter, cook the edible plants, and seek out more opportunities for survival than she did. That is, until their smartphone loses connection to the Internet.

And then again, the answer is yes, because although they may have access to a wealth of information, they still need the critical thinking skills, and human values that will help them to determine what is the right information, at the right time, and when it can do the most good. For that they need skills that they cannot pick up on their smartphones. They will need these skills to face the many challenges that we can prepare them for but cannot assist them with.

Once we recognize that our children are going to face challenges that we never had to deal with, then we have to admit that the education system that nurtured our information management skills might need updating. But that is a topic for another conversation.

For now, we need to understand that they will know more than we do with the swipe of a touchscreen, but they still need caring adults who can instill in them, toughness, compassion, fierceness, objectivity, discernment, and the most important 21st century skill, creativity.

Our children are awash in a sea of data, but we can teach them how to swim.

by Jeff Barnes



HARRODS NIGERIA'S PLAYGROUND

BY JOSEPH S FARODOYE

Harrods has always been a landmark institution which has long represented the epitome of luxury shopping in Great Britain. Frequented by so many well-known and famous clients including Her Royal Highness Queen Elisabeth II and who can forget the strong connection associated with Lady Diana and Dodi Fayed the former owner's (Mohamed Al-Fayed) late son.

As time and trends have passed, many nationalities have associated with the Harrods brand which has influenced so many of the luxurious brands available across its floors. With a rich variety of consumer goods, food, confectionary, fashion, jewellery, fragrance, crockery, leather goods and furniture items the vast eclectic mix is unmatched by any department store across the globe.

With millions of pounds spent daily, an amazing fact emerged regarding one of Harrods top tier spending groups. This may come as a surprise to many but the facts we are about to disclose have been echoed across so many luxury and premium brands including Moët Chandon, Mercedes and Virgin Atlantic to name a few.

In accordance with the Daily Mail and several other reliable sources within Harrods, it was revealed that every third pound spent in Harrods is by a Nigerian, when calculated this equates to a staggering £264,000,000 which is just under a third of the total annual turnover of Harrods that was generated in 2015. This was further compounded by the fact that a Nigerian based private equity firm was rumoured to be bidding to potentially purchase the Harrods department store.

Although this may come as a surprise to some of our readers the strong relationship and affinity to Nigeria has always been present, with some Nigerian clients flying to the UK specifically for weekly shopping trips to stock up on Harrods household essentials and spending in excess of £5,000 per trip. As a quintessential part of Harrods ethos to provide a personal service to their clients, this influx has been quickly acknowledged which has inspired a new Human Resources policy to employ Yoruba, Ibo and other Nigerian dialect speaking staff.

So what is it that Nigerians find so welcoming about Harrods? Is it the friendly staff, the essential food items in the food hall, the refreshing scents that fill the air of the fragrance department or is it the modern shelves of contemporary wear in men and women's clothing that make it so irresistible. Honestly, it is hard to determine but one thing is clearly evident - *"Wealthy Nigerians have truly adopted Harrods as their new playground"* and surrogate home away from home.

by Joseph S Farodoye,
Co-founder Africa Property Invest/ Estate Property Guide



THE
ESTATE
PROPERTY GUIDE

estatepropertyguide.com